

Edwards is saying that there is an **indissoluble** connection between something being known, and its being true. An indissoluble connection is one that cannot be broken.

But if the connection between God knowing that I will do X and me doing X is unbreakable, that implies:

“4. It is no less evident, that if there be a full, certain, and infallible foreknowledge of the future existence of the volitions of moral agents, then there is a certain infallible and indissoluble connection between those events and that foreknowledge.”

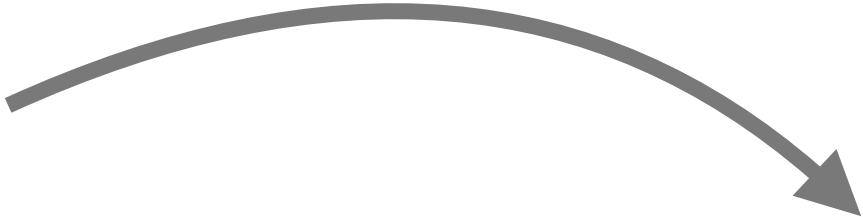
5. God knowing that we will perform some action necessitates that we will perform that action.

4. If we have no choice about some facts, and those facts necessitate X , we have no choice about X .

1. We have no choice about
past facts.

2. In the past, God had foreknowledge of our future actions.

3. We have no choice about
God's knowing that in
the future I will perform
a certain action. (1,2)





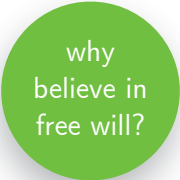
Note that this does **not** say that God's knowledge causes us to perform the action. It just says that it is impossible for God to know that I will do X, and I not do X.



two
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will



is fate
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why
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three
ways out

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1. We have no idea about

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for knowledge of our future

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22. In the past, God had



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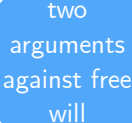
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Our first topic today is the oldest challenge to the existence of free will: the challenge to

freedom that comes from fate.



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responding to Edwards' argument. But

for fatality is n.

first let's think about how Edwards'

We'll shortly consider some ways of

argument might be related to an argument

actions. Could they give an argument

Edwards' argument — but did believe that

God— and hence rejected premise (2) of

Suppose that someone did not believe in

there were truths about all our future

similar to Edwards' argument?

with reference to the being of truth about

replace reference to God's foreknowledge

God only shows up in premises (2) and

our future actions.

(5) Let's look at what happens if we



2*In the past, there were truths about

perform a certain action (1,2)

God knows that in the future I will

3 We have not the fact that

then we have the choice about q.

1. We have no direct facts.

some action, then I will prefer that

choice about the fact that if p , then q ,

4. If we have no choice about p , and no

all of our activities.



that if it is true that I will perform

will perform various actions.

acaioid.

(3, 4, 5)

0 We have achieved what we

5* We have not decided what the fact

The fatalist argument

that Predict did not **take away** their free will; it just shows them that they

never had any. So they lacked free will before getting a Predictor.

So now consider a possible scenario in which someone exactly like you would get

a Predictor. By the above line of thought, this person would lack free will. But

But this person was stipulated to be exactly like you. So you don't have free will,

either.

things as fate, then there is no free will.

So far we've looked at two imaginary thought experiments—the story of Osmo,

and the example of the Predictor — which seem to show that if there is such a

Our question is: do either fatigue or foreknowledge pose a

serious challenge to the reality of free will?





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